'*Crossing Vaultbridge from the north,*' came Mandrax's reply. The Master of Executions sounded distracted, his breathing ragged, and Vurnok knew that Mandrax would soon lose himself to murderous obsession, becoming insensible to all but slaughter.

'Axeman, focus! Are your warriors in position? Have they cleared the emitters?'

A pause. Rasping breaths through Vurnok's vox-bead. Then, half-snarled, '*Yes.*'

'Shekktha, phase tertius,' ordered Vurnok. Again, crimson lines flared to life on his map, and he felt cruel satisfaction as he saw the loyalists cut off at the top of the stairwell. Even now, Mandrax's warriors were hitting them from one flank, Ethrok and Ferrox's from the other. Climbing the stairway amidst the whine of armour servos, Vurnok and his warriors pursued their victims into the kill-box.

Upon reaching the head of the stairs, Vurnok saw his prey had turned to fight back. This chamber was known to the Iron Warriors as the Command Gallery, and it had once been the bridge of a warship. It boasted cogitator banks and sensor pits, and it was dominated by sweeping vid-screens. Huge, grotesque visages grew from its walls wrought in brass and marble, each boasting a vox-speaker maw from which issued cacophonous static screams. Had the loyalists been able to pass through it, the Command Gallery offered several paths by which they might climb higher. However, they had been halted by the largest force field yet, which cut the chamber in half and presented them with a wall they could not pass.

The loyalists sought to break left or right through noisome side passages, but the warriors led by Mandrax, Ethrok and Ferrox blocked those routes and were even now pressing forward to assail the beleaguered Space Marines. Robbed of options, the loyalists took up a defensive stance and fought furiously. Scouts and Infiltrators ducked between firing positions, maintaining a deluge of shots, while their more-heavily armed battle-brothers formed a firebase around their commanders. Several intruders were already down, Vurnok saw, and more were wounded. Yet the Blood Angels and Tome Keepers did not look inclined to lay down their arms and surrender.

Good, he thought, spinning Ak'ghor in his hand and prowling into the fight. Then he caught sight of a loyalist Techmarine hunched over a control panel near the chamber's heart and working with fierce intensity. The loyalist was ringed by servitors that shielded him with their bodies, even as their heavy weapons spat fury at the Iron Warriors.

'Target their Techmarine,' Vurnok voxed. 'Whatever he seeks to do, prevent him.'

Vurnok took a shot with his combi-bolter, hitting one of the lumpen servitors and blasting its innards out of its back in a gory spray. Dead-eyed and unfeeling, the servitor faltered but did not fall. Vurnok snarled in disgust.

Before he could fire again, a band of Bladeguard came at him with vox-amplified battle cries. They were led by a warrior who held a chalice and wore scorched robes over his power armour. Vurnok's lip curled as he recognised a Sanguinary Priest. Bronzewrought Terminators pressed forward around their commander, and the chosen of Warsmith Czagra met the elite of the loyalist boarding party blade to blade.

Vurnok's daemon sword clashed with the howling teeth of the Sanguinary Priest's chainsword, sparks bursting from their impact. Roaring, Vurnok heaved his foe off balance and fired his combi-bolter point blank, only for a Bladeguard to block the salvo with his shield. Ak'ghor licked out and split the warrior's face-plate. As the Bladeguard reeled, one of Vurnok's Terminators ripped the loyalist's shield aside and rammed crackling talons through his armoured chest.

Spitting oaths, the Sanguinary Priest drove his stuttering, mangled chainsword into a fanged rent in the Terminator's armour. Mauve gore erupted in a geyser from the wound, and the hulking Iron Warrior crumpled with a vox-distorted gurgle. Chanting exhortations to his outnumbered warriors, the Sanguinary Priest ripped his weapon from the Terminator's fallen body and hacked at Vurnok's thigh, splitting cables and causing steam to vent from a ruptured exchanger.

Outraged, Vurnok drove Ak'ghor deep into the priest's side. He dragged the daemon blade free, blood flowing after it in a fine mist until the loyalist's Larraman's Organ kicked in and clotted the wound. Vurnok's decapitating backswing was parried by a Bladeguard's power sword. The master of the

BOARDING ACTION STRATAGEMS

If your Faction is **TASK FORCE BHAKIR**, then when playing a Boarding Actions game you will have access to the following Stratagems, and can spend CP to use them.

PRESCRIBED FUSILLADE 1CP

Task Force Bhakir – Boarding Actions – Battle Tactic Stratagem

Rigorously drilled en route by Sergeant Galzu in the fire discipline enshrined in the Hive Phorsis Protocol, the task force's battle-brothers can unleash precision fusillades even in the most claustrophobic of war zones.

Use this Stratagem in your Shooting phase, when a **TASK FORCE BHAKIR** unit from your army is selected to shoot. Until the end of the phase, each time a model in that unit makes an attack with a bolt weapon (see *Codex: Space Marines*), an unmodified hit roll of 5+, scores one additional hit.

THE DESERT KREYVAR 1CP

Task Force Bhakir – Boarding Actions – Battle Tactic Stratagem

Named for the lurking predator of the desert world of Santosh, Tome Keepers initiate this tactical positioning when faced with hidden threats, breaching and clearing suddenly revealed foes in an efficient and organised purge.

Use this Stratagem in your Movement phase, when a **TASK FORCE BHAKIR** unit from your army opens a Hatchway. If that unit is now within Engagement Range of one or more enemy models as a result of that Hatchway being opened, that **TASK FORCE BHAKIR** unit counts as having made a charge move against those enemy units this turn.

DARK INSIGHTS 1CP

Task Force Bhakir – Boarding Actions – Epic Deed Stratagem

Codicier Bhakir's skills in obfuscation make it easy for him to uncover and inflame the foe's own shrouded fears. He amplifies their hidden knowledge, stains of guilt and consuming obsessions to literally kill them with their own secrets.

Use this Stratagem in your Psychic phase, when a **TASK FORCE BHAKIR PSYKER** unit from your army manifests the Smite psychic power. When resolving that psychic power, the closest enemy unit within 18" of and visible to that **PSYKER** suffers 1 additional mortal wound.

THE PULPIT OF STONE 1CP

Task Force Bhakir – Boarding Actions – Epic Deed Stratagem

Galvanised by the knowledge of their mission's importance and the presence of so many heretics, the Tome Keepers adopt a resilient stance as laid out in the Liber Ahlberg, fighting on through the worst of injuries.

Use this Stratagem in your opponent's Shooting phase or the Fight phase, when a **TASK FORCE BHAKIR** unit from your army is selected as the target of an attack. Until the end of the phase, each time a model in that unit would lose a wound, roll one D6: on a 5+, that wound is not lost.

TRUTH AND HONOUR! 1CP

Task Force Bhakir – Boarding Actions – Strategic Ploy Stratagem

In the midst of the anarchic and insane innards of the Ark of Omen, the Tome Keepers cleave to the Chapter's principles of the quest for truth. Clues to the warp portal's location and meaning must be wrested from the foe and never relinquished.

Use this Stratagem at the start of your Command phase. Select one **TASK FORCE BHAKIR** unit from your army. Until the start of your next Command phase, each model in that unit counts as one additional model when determining control of an objective marker. You can only use this Stratagem once.

VEILED RECONNAISSANCE 1CP

Task Force Bhakir – Boarding Actions – Strategic Ploy Stratagem

A master of deceiving the Imperium's enemies, Codicier Bhakir casts an illusory shroud over his force's scouting elements, ensuring the Tome Keepers have unparalleled forward intelligence in order to pick their battles.

Use this Stratagem at the start of the first battle round. Select one **TASK FORCE BHAKIR** unit from your army. That unit can make a Normal Move of up to 6". You can only use this Stratagem once.



THE 5TH GRAND COMPANY

Faction: Chaos Space Marines **Total: 1500 points**
Legion: Iron Warriors **Command Points: 6**

BATTALION DETACHMENT
HQ

1 Abhorred Riddick
- *Daemon Prince*
- *Warlord Trait: Unyielding Mettle*
- *Relic: Gorget of Eternal Hate*
- *Hellforged Sword*
- *Mark of Khorne*

145 points

2 Dragoth Vaktrian
- *Lord Discordant*
- *Baleflamer, magma cutter*

175 points

TROOPS

3 Clavi Bracchinum
- *5 Legionaries*
- *Champion Dargron Algol*
- *Meltagun*

100 points

4 Spire Tyrants
- *5 Legionaries*
- *Champion Vhostok Gharrok*
- *Flamer, tainted chainaxe*

100 points

ELITES

5 Kruger Vogtoch
- *Master of Executions*

65 points

6 Bakulos Verrox
- *Helbrute (Dreadnought)*
- *Twin lascannon, helbrute fist*

125 points

7 Harkor Dreygur
- *Helbrute (Dreadnought)*
- *Twin lascannon, helbrute fist*

125 points

FAST ATTACK

8 Kurgo Syugh
- *Venomcrawler*

105 points

HEAVY SUPPORT

9 Tyranthikos
- *3 Obliterators*

270 points

10 Scarn Veltoch
- *Vindicator*

130 points

DEDICATED TRANSPORTS

11 Demens
- *Rhino*

80 points

12 Machina Arma
- *Rhino*

80 points



THE LUME IV BATTLE CONVOCATION

Faction: Adeptus Mechanicus **Total: 1469 points**
Forge World: Metalica **Command Points: 6**

BATTALION DETACHMENT
HQ

1 Prime Electrolid Qulo 1-Skae
- *Tech-Priest Dominus*
- *Warlord Trait: Tribute of Emphatic Veneration*
- *Relic: Anzion's Pseudogenetor*
- *Holy Order: Magi*
- *Eradication ray, phosphor serpenta*

115 points

2 Taurek 8-Psyda
- *Tech-Priest Dominus*
- *Volkite blaster*

75 points

TROOPS

3 Contubernium 56-Hae
- *5 Skitarii Rangers*

45 points

4 Contubernium 56-Gher
- *5 Skitarii Rangers*
- *Power sword, phosphor blast pistol, plasma caliver, enhanced data-tether*

75 points

5 Contubernium 57-Rook
- *10 Skitarii Vanguard*
- *Arc maul, arc rifle, omnispex*

115 points

6 Causarius 188-Leab
- *3 Kataphron Breachers*
- *2 Torsion Cannons, heavy arc rifle*

125 points

ELITES

7 Molinar 17-Util
- *Cybernetica Datasmith*

40 points

8 Evocatus 24-Hax
- *5 Fulgurite Electro-Priests*

70 points

9 Evocatus 28-Lobaq
- *10 Corpuscarii Electro-Priests*

140 points

FAST ATTACK

10 Sesquip 43-Yan
- *Ironstrider Ballistarii*
- *Twin cognis lascannons*

85 points

11 Alaris 44-Dja
- *3 Serberys Sulphurhounds*
- *Arc maul, phosphor blast carbine, phosphor blast pistol*

80 Points

12 Alaris 49-Kloane
- *3 Serberys Raiders*
- *Enhanced data-tether*

64 Points

HEAVY SUPPORT

13 Celeres 33-Har
- *2 Kastelan Robots*

180 Points

14 Cheiro 41-Kael
- *Onager Dunecrawler*
- *Neutron laser*

115 Points

15 Cheiro 42-Ejak
- *Skorpius Disintegrator*
- *Ferrumite cannon*

145 Points

hall were more full than they had been for years.

'Hail, Subcouncillor Thayne,' Bolk proclaimed before the crowd, 'and hail to ye, kin of the clans and iron-backed partisans of Greywater.'

He turned as he spoke, moving to the side of the desk, giving his address to the room. Thayne felt Bolk's shadow fall across him.

'I have consulted the wisdom of peers and ancestors, and I have determined that I must come before you, as one with the power to secure the legacy of Gerrig Durkar as he would have wanted. As is right.'

Thayne noted anticipatory tension in the air. *Something here passes, but may yet be made right.*

Bolk gave a gesture and the scribe Wynrik came forward bearing a long leather bundle, bound with a golden cord. He held it out for his master to take and withdrew. Bolk rested the object on the desk and began to unwrap it, speaking as he did so.

'There's grief in what I must share with you this day,' Bolk said. 'Bitterness, and dishonour also. Our kind are no strangers to these things, however.'

He turned a fold of leather, and Anki Thayne spied a flash of brilliant silver – *no...*

Gromril.

'Nor do we fear them!' Bolk continued, thunder in his voice. 'And nor do we fear the long wait for restitution – for how can we fear that which we were born to, that which is our birthright?'

At this he drew from the bundle a runic hand axe of superlative craftsmanship, raising it into the dappled light of the hall. All present could see that the weapon was ancient. It prompted in the assembled Dispossessed not just fascination, but also pride and indignation. Here was a piece of home. *But only a piece.*

Riggen Bolk waited until he had wholly captured his audience, and then he told his tale.

In his own way, the origins of Riggen Bolk were as mysterious as those of Gerrig Durkar. This was no accident, he explained. They were both war orphans, both kinless from an early age, and they had known one another well. Durkar, slightly the elder, was the more cautious of the two, while hot-tempered Bolk had seen them clear of encounters with quick-handed sneak-thieves and brutish fensmen. They might, Bolk added pointedly, have been brothers.

Years had passed in this manner and their bond had grown ever closer. *Why was this not more widely known?* Bolk asked. The answer to that lay amid the horrors of war.

Gerrig Durkar had been fortunate in one regard: he possessed a single relic of his kin, the selfsame axe of gromril that Bolk had brought forth. Yet in his youth Durkar had been no warrior, quite the opposite: his mind was ever set on the problems and opportunities of industry. His ancestral axe remained bound in leather, and young Riggen Bolk did enough fighting for them both.

Then green terror had come to Greywater Fastness and left Durkar with little choice but to take up the weapon of his people. The Sylvaneth came at night, taking advantage of a poorly managed stretch of wilderness at the city's fringe in order to steal into an artillery blind spot. Vicious treelords wrenched a gap in the walls wide enough to grant passage to a tide of shrieking tree revenants, spiteful avatars of the barbarous wild. Their viciousness was such that it sent the smallfolk of the lower city into a panic, surging for the protection of the inner walls. Even the aelves, Bolk noted, recoiled from the cruelties of their supposed kin.

It was then that Greywater gave them its renowned welcome, smashing treelords to flaming splinters with Arsenal cannonades and scattering the horde with punishing Helstorm salvoes. The two young duardin had found themselves trapped in a burning district, their own survival far from guaranteed, but it had been then, Bolk declared, that he knew the course his life must take. He watched vicious dragonspites torn from the air by the guns of the Gyrocopter Corps, felt himself galvanised by the deafening report of drakefire guns and knew that his duty lay with the indomitable Ironweld.

This was a dire moment, however. Riggen Bolk took up a flaming brand to keep the tree revenants at bay as they retreated towards the inner walls; Durkar swung his ancestral axe with inexpert desperation. Then, trapped in a burning alley, their death came for them.

It took the form of a prowling dryad, stalking them with scythe in hand, its body writhing with venomous insects. One of these struck forth at young Durkar and seized him at the neck, biting deep. Bolk lost his nerve then, he noted with regret, allowing himself to be overcome by fear. Treacherous aelf-song shuddered within him, and he collapsed to the ground. That was when Durkar's axe found its way into Riggen Bolk's hands, where it rested as weighty as an oath undertaken. Bolk set about the dryad until he was slick with its black ichor, and then he hauled the two of them to safety.

When he woke, Durkar insisted that Bolk keep the weapon, pledging it as partial repayment for the immeasurable debt he owed. Bolk had refused, of course, which prompted Durkar to admit that the sight of it filled